

UPSC INDIAN POLITY

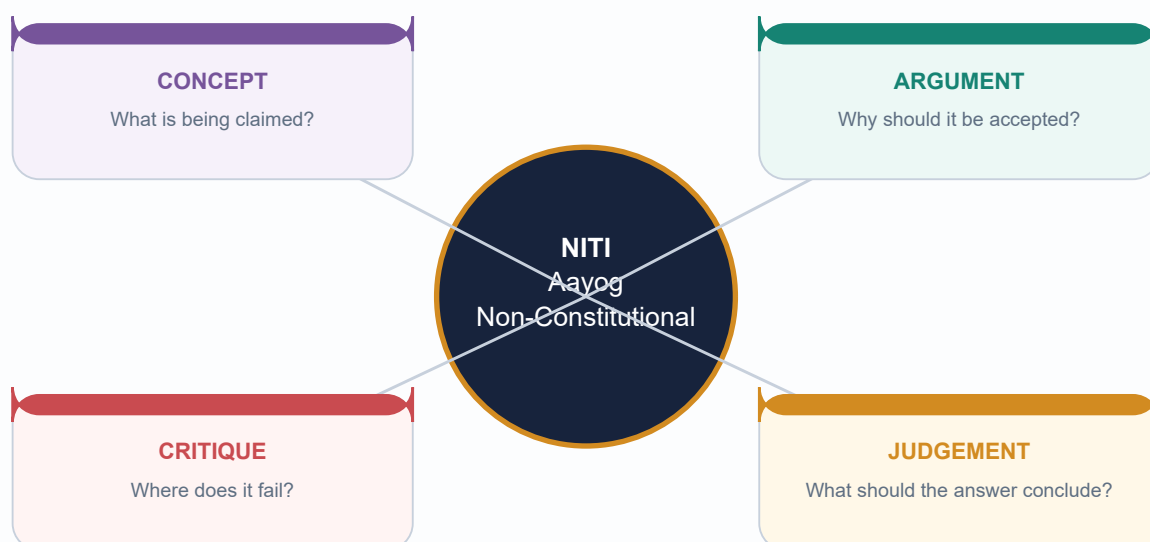
NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE Deep-Learning Visual Notes

Indian Polity · GS Paper II · Prelims + Mains

Layer 1: Basic foundation · Layer 2: Advanced constitutional and exam depth

Sources: NITI-Aayog.md + 34_NITI-Aayog.md

Learning cards: 16



Facts from official sources | Inferences clearly marked | No fabricated data

HIGH UPSC RELEVANCE

HIGH

Foundation · Core Foundation

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

greater than **Subject:** Polity · **Tier:** Basic (foundation) · **GS-II / GS-III***Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

STATIC THEORY

• greater than □ = from book · □ = current link · □ = mnemonic. *Deep dive → advanced/34_NITI-Aayog.md.*

MEMORY HOOK

greater than □ = from book · □ = current link · □ = mnemonic. *Deep dive → advanced/34_NITI-Aayog.md.*

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. greater than = from book · □ = current link · □ = mnemonic. *Deep dive → advanced/34_NITI-Aayog.md.*

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Core Foundation

HIGH

Foundation · Snapshot

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Item	Fact
Full form	National Institution for Transforming India
Established	1 January 2015 (replaced Planning Commission)
Nature	Non-constitutional & non-statutory (executive resolution)
Chairperson	Prime Minister

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Snapshot

HIGH

Foundation · Core idea

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

NITI Aayog is the government's **premier policy think tank** — it replaced the top-down, fund-allocating Planning Commission with an **advisory, bottom-up, cooperative-federalism** model. It **recommends** but does **not allocate funds** (that's the Finance Ministry).

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

CORE IDEA: RECALL MAP

Core idea

Dimension 1

NITI Aayog is the government's premier policy think tank — it replaced the top-down, fund-allocating Planning Commission with an advisory, bottom-up,

Dimension 2

greater than □ Planning Commission = allocated funds (top-down); NITI Aayog = advises (bottom-up).

Dimension 3

greater than □ 4 functions: policy design · cooperative federalism · monitoring & evaluation · think-tank.

STATIC THEORY

- greater than □ **Planning Commission = allocated funds (top-down); NITI Aayog = advises (bottom-up).**
- greater than □ **4 functions:** policy design · cooperative federalism · monitoring & evaluation · think-tank.

MEMORY HOOK

greater than Planning Commission = allocated funds (top-down); NITI Aayog = advises (bottom-up). | greater than 4 functions: policy design · cooperative federalism · monitoring & evaluation · think-tank.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — **ADVANCED / COMPLETE** → Core idea

HIGH

Foundation · Must-Know Facts

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ Chair = **PM**; **Vice-Chair** (PM-appointed, Cabinet-Minister rank); **CEO** (Secretary rank).

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS: RECALL MAP

Must-Know Facts

Dimension 1 ☐ Chair = PM; Vice-Chair (PM-appointed, Cabinet-Minister rank); CEO (Secretary rank).	Dimension 2 ☐ Governing Council = all state CMs + UT (legislature) CMs + LGs of other UTs.
Dimension 3 ☐ Wings: Research, Consultancy, Team India.	Dimension 4 ☐ No fund-allocation power; only recommends.

STATIC THEORY

- ☐ **Governing Council** = all state CMs + UT (legislature) CMs + LGs of other UTs.
- ☐ Wings: **Research, Consultancy, Team India**.
- ☐ **No fund-allocation power**; only recommends.
- ☐ Five-Year Plans ended (**12th Plan 2012–17**) → replaced by 3-yr Action Agenda / 7-yr Strategy / 15-yr Vision.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Chair = **PM**; **Vice-Chair** (PM-appointed, Cabinet-Minister rank); **CEO** (Secretary rank).
2. **Governing Council** = all state CMs + UT (legislature) CMs + LGs of other UTs.
3. Wings: **Research, Consultancy, Team India**.
4. **No fund-allocation power**; only recommends.
5. Five-Year Plans ended (**12th Plan 2012–17**) → replaced by 3-yr Action Agenda / 7-yr Strategy / 15-yr Vision.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — **ADVANCED / COMPLETE** → Must-Know Facts

HIGH

Foundation • ☐ Current linkGS-II Indian
Polity

NEWS TRIGGER

☐ ☐ ☐ Flagship tools: **SDG India Index, Aspirational Districts/Blocks Programme, MPI**. Criticised as a "toothless think tank" without the Planning Commission's fund clout — feeding the **cooperative-vs-coercive federalism** debate.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of ☐ Current link.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — **ADVANCED / COMPLETE** → ☐ Current link

HIGH

Advanced • Core Foundation

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

greater than **Subject:** Polity • **Tier:** Advanced (exam depth) • **GS Paper:** GS-II / GS-III

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

CORE FOUNDATION: RECALL MAP

Core Foundation

Dimension 1 greater than Subject: Polity • Tier: Advanced (exam depth) • GS Paper: GS-II / GS-III	Dimension 2 greater than Grounded in: Indian Polity by M. Laxmikant, Ch. 54 (direct check of the local Sixth Revised Edition PDF).
Dimension 3 greater than □ = from source book • □□ = inference / analysis • □ = current affairs.	Dimension 4 greater than Companion: basic/NITI-Aayog.md.

STATIC THEORY

- greater than **Grounded in:** Indian Polity by M. Laxmikant, Ch. 54 (direct check of the local Sixth Revised Edition PDF).
- greater than □ = from source book • □□ = inference / analysis • □ = current affairs.
- greater than *Companion: basic/NITI-Aayog.md.*
- greater than
- greater than □□ **Note:** NITI Aayog is **neither a constitutional nor a statutory body** — it was created by an **executive
- greater than resolution** of the Union Cabinet (like the erstwhile Planning Commission).

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. greater than = from source book • □□ = inference / analysis • □ = current affairs.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Core Foundation

HIGH

Advanced • PART A — ESTABLISHMENT □

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

- The 65-year-old **Planning Commission** was scrapped on **13 Aug 2014**; **NITI Aayog (National Institution for Transforming India)** was established on **1 January 2015** as its successor — by an **executive resolution** (so **non-constitutional & non-statutory / extra-constitutional**).

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

PART A — ESTABLISHMENT □: RECALL MAP

PART A — ESTABLISHMENT □

Dimension 1 □ The 65-year-old Planning Commission was scrapped on 13 Aug 2014; NITI Aayog (National Institution for Transforming India) was established on 1 Janua	Dimension 2 □ India's premier policy "Think Tank" — provides directional & policy inputs; a "Bharatiya approach to
Dimension 3 development."	Dimension 4 □ Replaces the Planning Commission's one-way, top-down, command-and-control flow with a bottom-up,

STATIC THEORY

- India's **premier policy "Think Tank"** — provides directional & policy inputs; a ***Bharatiya approach to
- development."**
- Replaces the Planning Commission's **one-way, top-down, command-and-control** flow with a **bottom-up,
- collaborative **partnership of states** — cooperative federalism**.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

- The 65-year-old **Planning Commission** was scrapped on **13 Aug 2014**; **NITI Aayog (National Institution for Transforming India)** was established on **1 January 2015** as its successor — by an **executive resolution** (so **non-constitutional & non-statutory / extra-constitutional**).
- India's **premier policy "Think Tank"** — provides directional & policy inputs; a ***Bharatiya approach to
- Replaces the Planning Commission's **one-way, top-down, command-and-control** flow with a **bottom-up,

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART A — ESTABLISHMENT □

HIGH

Advanced • PART B — COMPOSITION □ • Table 1.1

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the advanced source layer.

KEY DATA

Component	Detail
□ Chairperson	The Prime Minister
□ Governing Council	CMs of all states + CMs of UTs with legislatures (Delhi, Puducherry, J&K;) + LGs of other UTs
□ Regional Councils	For issues spanning multiple states/regions; formed for a fixed tenure; convened by the PM
□ Vice-Chairperson	Appointed by the PM; rank of Cabinet Minister
□ Full-time Members	Rank of Minister of State
□ Part-time Members	Max 2 (from universities/research bodies, rotational)
□ Ex-officio Members	Max 4 Union ministers (nominated by the PM)
□ CEO	Appointed by the PM for a fixed tenure; rank of Secretary to the GoI

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART B — COMPOSITION □

HIGH

Advanced · PART B — COMPOSITION □ · Table 1.2

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the advanced source layer.

KEY DATA

Component	Detail
□ Special Invitees	Domain experts nominated by the PM

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART B — COMPOSITION □

HIGH

Advanced · Specialised wings □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Research Wing (in-house think tank) · **Consultancy Wing** (match-making with private/public expertise) · **Team India Wing** (representatives of every state & ministry — the liaison for cooperative federalism).

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Specialised wings □

HIGH

Advanced · PART C — OBJECTIVES & FUNCTIONS □

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ **Four core functions:** (1) Design policy & programme framework; (2) Foster cooperative federalism; (3) Monitoring & evaluation; (4) Think-tank / Knowledge & Innovation Hub.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

PART C — OBJECTIVES & FUNCTIONS □: RECALL MAP

PART C — OBJECTIVES & FUNCTIONS □

Dimension 1 □ Four core functions: (1) Design policy & programme framework; (2) Foster cooperative federalism; (3) Monitoring & evaluation; (4) Think-tank / Knowl	Dimension 2 □ Two hubs: Team India Hub (cooperative federalism + policy design) & Knowledge & Innovation Hub
Dimension 3 (resource centre / best practices).	Dimension 4 □□ Key limitation: NITI Aayog only recommends — it has NO power to allocate funds (that power moved to

STATIC THEORY

- □ Two hubs: **Team India Hub** (cooperative federalism + policy design) & **Knowledge & Innovation Hub**
- (resource centre / best practices).
- □□ **Key limitation:** NITI Aayog **only recommends** — it has **NO power to allocate funds** (that power moved to
- the **Finance Ministry**). It cannot impose plans on states.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. **Four core functions:** (1) Design policy & programme framework; (2) Foster cooperative federalism; (3) Monitoring & evaluation; (4) Think-tank / Knowledge & Innovation Hub.
2. Two hubs: **Team India Hub** (cooperative federalism + policy design) & **Knowledge & Innovation Hub**

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART C — OBJECTIVES & FUNCTIONS □

HIGH

Advanced · PART D — PLANNING COMMISSION vs NITI AAYOG (compare) □□

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the advanced source layer.

KEY DATA

Point	Planning Commission (1950–2014)	NITI Aayog (2015–)
□ Basis	Executive resolution	Executive resolution
□ Role	Allocated funds/grants to states	Advisory think tank — no fund allocation
□ Federal approach	Top-down (command)	Bottom-up (cooperative)
□ Plans	Five-Year Plans (imposed)	Strategy/vision docs, no imposition
□□ States' role	Passive recipients	Equal partners (Governing Council)
□□ Members	Full-time economists	PM-led + CMs + experts

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STUDY LINK

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART D — PLANNING COMMISSION vs NITI AAYOG (compare) □□

HIGH

Advanced · PART D — PLANNING COMMISSION vs NITI AAYOG (compare) □□

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□□ **Note:** Five-Year Plans ended with the **12th Plan (2012–17)**; NITI Aayog issued a **3-year Action Agenda**, a **7-year Strategy** and a **15-year Vision** document instead.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART D — PLANNING COMMISSION vs NITI AAYOG (compare) □□

HIGH

Advanced · UPSC Traps

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Ministry**.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: NITI Aayog is a constitutional/statutory body

CORRECT: it is **neither** (executive resolution).

WRONG: NITI Aayog allocates funds to states

CORRECT: it is **advisory only**; fund allocation is with the ****Finance**

WRONG: The President is the chairperson

CORRECT: the **Prime Minister**.

WRONG: Governing Council excludes UT chiefs

CORRECT: includes **CMs of UTs with legislatures + LGs of other UTs**.

WRONG: NITI Aayog still makes Five-Year Plans

CORRECT: those **ended** (12th Plan 2012–17); it makes vision/strategy docs.

WRONG: The Vice-Chairperson has Cabinet Minister rank but is elected

CORRECT: **appointed by the PM**.

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — **ADVANCED / COMPLETE** → UPSC Traps

HIGH**Advanced • CA hooks****GS-II** Indian Polity**NEWS TRIGGER**

□ □ □ **SDG India Index, Aspirational Districts / Aspirational Blocks Programme, Multidimensional Poverty Index** — NITI's flagship monitoring tools. □ □ □ Criticism that NITI Aayog is a **toothless think tank** without the Planning Commission's fund clout — the

INTRO & ORIGIN

cooperative-vs-coercive federalism debate (states boycotting Governing Council meetings).

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

• □ □ □ **NITI Aayog @ development finance / green transition / AI strategy** reports shaping policy.

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — **ADVANCED / COMPLETE** → □ CA hooks

HIGH

Advanced • Mains angles

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Mains angles.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

"NITI Aayog replaced allocation with advice — has it strengthened or weakened planning?" Examine. Cooperative federalism in practice: is NITI Aayog living up to its founding promise? The vacuum in India's planning architecture after the Planning Commission — assess.

STUDY LINK

NITI Aayog (Non-Constitutional, Non-Statutory Body) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Mains angles

End of Register Notes — UPSC Agent / Copilot CLI